WSTI AI Hackathon — Team Cheatsheet

Your step-by-step guide from idea to demo. Work through each phase as a team. Tick off items as you go.

PHASE 1: DEFINE YOUR PROBLEM (Friday Night + Saturday Morning)

Before you touch any code, get crystal clear on what you are solving.

☐ Write your problem statement in one sentence: "People who [WHO] struggle with [WHAT] because [WHY]"
☐ Identify your target user — be specific (not "everyone", think "aged care nurses in Western Sydney")
☐ List 3 real pain points your user has today
☐ Describe the current workaround (how do they cope without your solution?)
☐ Define success: what does "solved" look like for your user?

💡 *Tip: Talk to someone in the room who might be your user. 5 minutes of conversation beats 2 hours of guessing.*

PHASE 2: DESIGN BEFORE YOU BUILD (Saturday Morning)

Think on paper before you think in code. This saves hours.

☐ Sketch your solution on paper or whiteboard — what does the user see first?
☐ Map the user journey: User opens app → does what → gets what result?
☐ List your core features (MAX 3 for the hackathon — be ruthless)
☐ Identify your "wow moment" — the one thing that makes judges say "that is clever"
☐ Decide your tech stack as a team (what AI tools, what framework, what platform?)
☐ Create a simple data model — what information does your app need to store/process?

The Design Thinking Flow:

Empathise → Define → Ideate → Prototype → Test
You are in Empathise/Define now. Do not skip to Prototype.

PHASE 3: SET UP YOUR TEAM (Saturday Morning)

Assign roles early. Not everyone should code.

☐ **Assign a Team Lead — makes final scope decisions, keeps time**
- Owns the project timeline and keeps the team on track
- Decides what to cut when time runs out (scope is your job)
- Runs the morning standup: "What did we do? What is next? What is blocking us?"
- Makes the final call on feature disagreements

☐ **Assign Builder(s) — writes the code, builds the prototype**
- Sets up the project repo/workspace and picks the tech stack
- Builds the core feature first, then layers on extras
- Commits code regularly — never go more than 1 hour without saving
- Pairs with AI coding tools but reviews and understands the output

☐ **Assign a Designer — UI/UX, user flow, visual polish**
- Creates a simple brand style: pick 2-3 colours, 1 font, logo/icon
- Designs the user flow: what screens, what order, what interactions
- Makes wireframes/mockups before the builder codes the UI
- Polishes the final product: consistent layout, clean visuals, good spacing
- Creates screenshots and visuals for the pitch video

☐ **Assign a Pitcher — owns the 3-min video and live demo story**
- Writes the pitch script: problem → solution → demo → impact → team
- Plans the demo path — the exact click-through for the video
- Leads the Show & Tell presentations (Sunday 3:30pm)
- Records and edits the final 3-min video (due 26 Apr)
- Practises the story: make judges feel the problem before showing the solution

☐ **Assign a Domain Expert — knows the problem space, validates decisions**
- Validates that the solution actually solves a real problem (not an imagined one)
- Provides real-world scenarios for testing ("a nurse would actually do X, not Y")
- Researches competitors/existing solutions — what already exists?
- Feeds the pitcher with impact data and real stories for the video
- Sanity-checks features: "would our user actually use this?"

☐ Exchange phone numbers and add each other on Discord team channel
☐ Agree on working hours for Saturday and Sunday

Note: One person can wear multiple hats. But every team needs at least one builder and one pitcher.

PHASE 4: BUILD SMART WITH AI (Saturday + Sunday)

Use AI to accelerate, not replace your thinking.

☐ Write a simple PRD (Product Requirements Doc) before coding — even 10 bullet points helps
☐ Create wireframes or mockups first (pen & paper, Figma, or AI-generated)
☐ Set up your project repo / workspace
☐ Build your core feature FIRST — get one thing working end-to-end
☐ Use AI coding tools (Cursor, Claude, Copilot, Lovable, Bolt, Replit etc.)
☐ Share AI tool costs within your team if needed (licences for build)
☐ Test with a real scenario — does it actually solve the problem you defined?
☐ Commit and save your work regularly — do not lose progress!

AI Coding Best Practices:

• Start with a spec/PRD, not with "build me an app"
• Give AI context: paste your problem statement, user journey, data model
• Build incrementally: get one feature working before adding the next
• Review AI output — do not blindly accept, understand what it wrote
• If stuck, ask the AI/Tech support table for help (dedicated mentor table all weekend)

🌐 Bonus: Create a Business Landing Page

Alongside your app, consider building a simple website for your project. This is a great exercise for non-tech team members using vibecoding tools (Lovable, Bolt, etc.).

- Shows business maturity and market understanding to judges
- Non-technical builders get hands-on vibecoding experience — great learning opportunity
- Gives your team a professional home for demos, video, and future communication
- Include: problem statement, solution overview, team bios, link to app, contact
- Does not need to be perfect — a clean one-pager beats no web presence

PHASE 5: POLISH AND PREPARE (Sunday Afternoon)

Stop building new features by 2pm Sunday. Polish what you have.

☐ Freeze features by 2:00pm — no new functionality after this
☐ Fix the top 3 bugs that break the demo flow
☐ Make sure your demo path works end-to-end without errors

☐ Clean up the UI — consistent fonts, colours, alignment
☐ Prepare your Show & Tell (Sunday 3:30pm) — 2 min progress share per team
☐ Take screenshots and screen recordings for your video later

💡 *Note: This is your feature freeze for the BUILD WEEKEND only. You should keep iterating, improving, and polishing your product in the days after — right up until the submission deadline on 26 April 11:59pm. Use the coaching sessions (14 & 21 Apr) to get feedback and refine.*

PHASE 6: YOUR 3-MINUTE VIDEO (Due 26 April)

This is what judges will evaluate. Start planning now, record after the weekend.

☐ Example Structure: Problem (30s) → Solution demo (90s) → Impact & why it matters (30s) → Team (10s)
☐ Show the working product, not slides — live demo or screen recording
☐ Lead with a real story: "Meet Sarah, she is a nurse who..."
☐ Show the AI in action — what is the AI actually doing?
☐ Keep it under 3 minutes — judges will stop watching after 3:00
☐ Submit video + app URL by Sun 26 Apr 11:59pm (submission form provided 14 Apr)

KEY DATES TO REMEMBER

📅 Sat 11 Apr — Build Day 1 (9am-5pm, Show & Tell at 4pm, close sharp 5pm)
📅 Sun 12 Apr — Build Day 2 (9am-5pm, Final Showcase 3:30pm, What's Next 4:30pm)
📅 Tue 14 Apr — Build Update, Check-in & Solution Coaching #1 @ WSSH 6-8pm [MANDATORY]
📅 Tue 21 Apr — Build Update, Check-in & Solution Coaching #2 @ WSSH 6-8pm [MANDATORY]
📅 Thu 23 Apr — Pitch Coaching @ LaunchPad
📅 Sun 26 Apr — Video + App URL submission deadline 11:59pm
📅 Thu 30 Apr — Grand Finale @ Level 1, 6 Hassall St, Parramatta

NEED HELP?

🛠️ AI/Tech Support Table — dedicated mentor table all weekend (Saturday + Sunday)
💬 Discord — post questions in your team channel
📋 Support staff check-ins on 14 & 21 Apr

Good luck! Build something real. See you at the Grand Finale. 🚀

RESOURCES (Examples)

🎨 Design Resources

Google Stitch — Free AI design tool from Google Labs. Generate complete UI designs from text prompts. No design skills needed. 350 free generations/month.
• Create multi-screen app mockups in minutes from plain English
• Export production-ready code (HTML, CSS, Tailwind, Flutter, SwiftUI)
• Save your design system in a DESIGN.md file for consistency
• Voice Canvas: speak to your canvas and get real-time design feedback
🔗 https://stitch.withgoogle.com
🔗 Guide: https://blog.google/innovation-and-ai/models-and-research/google-labs/stitch-ai-ui-design/

💻 Vibe Coding Tools — Build Apps Without Coding

Vibe coding = describe what you want in plain English, AI writes the code. Perfect for non-technical team members.

Top tools for beginners:

• Lovable (lovable.dev) — Easiest for complete beginners, great for landing pages and web apps
• Bolt.new (bolt.new) — Simple interface, built-in preview, has free tier
• Replit Agent (replit.com) — Best for non-technical users, builds full apps from conversation
• Cursor (cursor.com) — AI-first code editor, great for those with some tech comfort
• Claude Code — Deepest reasoning, 1M token context, best for complex builds
• Antigravity (Google) — AI-powered app builder
• Codex (OpenAI) — Cloud-based coding agent

💡 *Tip: Pair Google Stitch (design) with a vibe coding tool (build) — design your screens first, then hand the mockup to your builder.*

(More resources will be added — check back!)